

1. The Problem

Training for Tough Conversations is Hard

Sales and support teams—especially small ones—face a difficult challenge:

- Role-playing with colleagues is awkward and doesn't scale.
- Learning on the job with real customers risks relationships and revenue.
- Generic scripts rarely reproduce the pressure and timing of a real voice call.

They need a lightweight, accessible way to **practice** difficult conversations before the real call.

2. The Product

Sparring: Practice by Voice

Sparring is designed to provide short, repeatable voice practice with a simulated customer.

- **Select:** Choose a difficult scenario (e.g., late delivery, price comparison, cancellation request).
- **Practice:** Talk to a simulated customer who challenges vague answers and raises realistic objections.
- **Review:** Understand the evidence behind your feedback.
- **Repeat:** Practice a better response to build confidence.

3. In Action

Demo Scenario: Late Delivery

Example scenario: a customer asks for a 30% discount after a delayed order. The trainee has limited authority and must offer a policy-safe next step.

During the call: each finalized trainee response supplies evidence for the rubric. The server checks exact quotes and updates the observed criteria. A 0–100 score is shown only when at least 60% of the weighted rubric has been observed.

The session ends with targeted coaching: one strength, one area for improvement, and an alternative response that stays within company policy.

4. Technology

Built for Trust & Transparency

- **Voice interaction:** The browser connects to AssemblyAI's Voice Agent API using a short-lived server-issued token.
- **Deterministic Turn Scoring:** Every finalized trainee transcript is scored server-side against the rubric in real time, validating quoted evidence before updating criteria.
- **Optional Tool Support:** The Voice Agent can also call `log_objection` and `score_rubric` to propose observations directly; the server validates these the same way.

Limits: Scores are formative feedback, not certification. Coverage shows how much of the rubric was observed; unobserved criteria remain unscored.

5. Business Value

Practice Before the Real Call

- **Buyer hypothesis:** Small Spanish-speaking sales and support teams need repeatable practice without a complex rollout.
- **Distinctive loop:** Short voice role-play, evidence-backed feedback, and immediate retry.
- **Business hypothesis:** A team subscription with custom company scenarios; pricing and demand still need pilot validation.
- **Pilot measure:** Completion, perceived usefulness, and whether the next attempt improves one specific behavior.

The builder completed a live voice practice. Automated regression tests and live checks are documented separately. Team pilots are the next step.

6. Next Steps

Roadmap & Access

- **Immediate Next Step:** Human calibration testing and small-team pilots.
- **Future:** Team-specific scenarios, opt-in practice history, and measured coaching outcomes.

Demo: sparring.visitaremota.com

Source Code: github.com/jlmawyin/sparring